

Palliative Care Case Scenario Assignment

Assignment Instructions

Create an original palliative care case scenario involving a patient with a chronic life-limiting illness.

Your scenario must include the following components:

1. Patient Profile

Include:

- Age
- Gender
- Chronic life-limiting diagnosis
- Specific symptoms client currently experiencing – as learned in this course (eg: pain, nausea, etc.)
- Living situation (rural, urban, indigenous reservation, apartment, house, etc.)
- Family/support systems (married, children, etc.) and family//caregiver concerns

2. Cultural or Religious Considerations

Describe a cultural, spiritual, or religious belief that influences the patient's care.

Examples *may* include:

- Indigenous beliefs and traditions
- Christianity
- Islam
- Judaism
- Hinduism
- Sikhism
- Buddhism
- Cultural traditions related to death and dying
- Etc....

Explain how these beliefs affect:

- Treatment decisions
- End-of-life care preferences
- Communication
- Spiritual practices

3. Person-Centered Care

Demonstrate how the healthcare team respects the patient's:

- Values
- Goals
- Preferences
- Wishes for end-of-life care

Include examples of:

- Shared decision-making
- Respect for autonomy
- Individualized care planning
- Comfort Basket contents

4. Palliative Care Needs (Describe interventions that could address each need)

Identify and describe at least three needs from the following domains, specific to your client:

- Physical
- Emotional
- Social
- Spiritual

5. Family and Caregiver Considerations

Discuss:

- Family concerns
- Caregiver stress
- Support services that may be needed

6. Interprofessional Team Involvement

Identify at least four healthcare professionals that could be involved in the patient's care and explain their roles.

Examples:

- Nurse
- Physician
- Social worker
- Spiritual care provider
- Personal support worker
- Pharmacist
- Occupational therapist

7. Reflection

In 250–300 words, explain:

- Why person-centered care is important in your scenario.
- How cultural or religious beliefs influenced care planning.
- What challenges healthcare providers might face and how they could address them.

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1) Patient Scenario Development

Scenario is realistic, comprehensive, and clearly reflects a patient requiring palliative care. All relevant patient details are included.

Scenario is realistic and includes most relevant details.

Scenario is somewhat realistic but lacks important details or clarity.

Scenario is incomplete, unrealistic, or lacks essential information.

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2) Cultural/Religious Considerations

Cultural or religious beliefs are clearly described and thoughtfully integrated into the care plan. Demonstrates excellent understanding of cultural competence.

Cultural or religious beliefs are identified and appropriately connected to care.

Cultural or religious beliefs are mentioned but have limited connection to care planning.

Minimal or no consideration of cultural or religious factors.

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3) Person-Centered Care

Demonstrates a strong understanding of person-centered care, including patient values, preferences, autonomy, and shared decision-making.

Demonstrates a good understanding of person-centered care with relevant examples.

Demonstrates a basic understanding of person-centered care but lacks depth or examples.

Limited or no evidence of person-centered care principles.

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4) Palliative Care Needs and Interventions

Identifies multiple physical, emotional, social, and/or spiritual needs and provides appropriate, evidence-informed interventions.

Identifies several needs and provides appropriate interventions.

Identifies some needs but interventions are incomplete or lack detail.

Needs and interventions are poorly identified or missing.

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5) Critical Thinking and Reflection

Reflection demonstrates insightful analysis of the patient's needs, cultural/religious considerations, and person-centered care. Challenges and solutions are thoughtfully explored.

Reflection demonstrates good analysis and understanding.

Reflection demonstrates basic understanding with limited analysis.

Reflection is superficial, incomplete, or missing.

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Total of 3-4 pages, NOT including title page and reference page
Times New Roman; Arial; size 12 font; double spaced, well-organized
Total points = 20
Worth 30% of final grade

Due date: July 26, 2026 by 2300 hr